Ujjwal Nigam

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Education

UC Santa Cruz Sept. 2024 – Present
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics *Santa Cruz, CA*

- GPA: 3.73
- Relevant Coursework: Econometrics, Intermediate Macro and Micro Theory, Statistical Methods for Economics, Machine Learning for Economists, Advanced Quantitative Methods, Role of Statistics in Economics, Python for Data Science, Linear Algebra, Calculus I-III

Experience

UC Santa Cruz Economics Department - Small Farm Economics Lab Sept. 2026 – Present
Research Assistant *Santa Cruz, CA*

- Applied STATA to analyze data on land consolidation among agricultural firms; produced findings in a technical policy brief

Campaign for College Opportunity August 2026 - Sept. 2026
Policy Research Contractor *Remote*

- Compiled research bibliography summarizing key talking points on both sides of debate regarding reinstatement of standardized testing in the UC system
- Produced a policy memo on standardized testing and the holistic review that identified messaging that resonated most with students, recommending key talking points
- Presented policy memo to team of policy experts to inform advocacy efforts

UC Santa Cruz Financial Affairs August 2026 - Sept. 2026
Payroll and Operations Intern *Remote*

- Conducted statistical analysis of timesheet data to improve compliance rates in payroll department
- Developed metrics and dashboards to visualize timesheet data over time and by department

UC Students Association March 2026
Student Delegate and Lobbyist *Sacramento, CA*

- Represented UC Santa Cruz at student conference in Davis alongside 10 other delegates
- Lobbied California state representatives for UCSA legislative priorities, ranging from expanding food accessibility to increasing student representation in the UC Board of Regents

Projects

Evaluating the Impacts of California's Cap-and-Invest Initiative March 2026

- Applied a synthetic control and differences-in-differences hybrid approach to analyze environmental policy in California
- Utilized R to merge, visualize, and examine data collected from FRED, Census Bureau, and Bureau of Economic Analysis

Skills

Programming: Python, R, STATA
Data Visualization: QGIS, Canva
Tools: LaTeX, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace